

Subject: [ASD] Small stand-up follow-up for this week and other tasks
To: Scrum Master (Cc: Tech Lead)

Dear Scrum Master,

Please convey my thanks to your team for the team's active participation in last week's stand-up workshop. It was great to observe so many teams practicing both the fragrant and the rather less fragrant variants of Scrum-style coordination meetings.

For this week, I would like your team to do one small follow-up exercise *at the end of your team stand-up*.

Please briefly discuss and note down the following three points:

1. **One smell you noticed during your stand-up**

For example: status reporting instead of coordination, blockers not being surfaced, too much technical deep-diving, lack of focus on the weekly goal, one person dominating, no concrete next steps, team members sitting instead of standing, etc.

2. **One thing your team deliberately did better than before**

For example: surfacing blockers earlier, focusing more clearly on the weekly goal, keeping things shorter, asking more explicitly for help, ending with concrete follow-up actions, giving quieter team members more room, and so on.

3. **One pledge for the next stand-up**

What will your team try to do better next week?

Please keep this intentionally short and lightweight. The goal is not bureaucracy, but reflection and improvement.

As Scrum Master, please make sure this mini-exercise happens in your team directly after the meeting. Please keep a short summary (keywords) with the three points in your Scrum Master notes; it will be included in next week's Scrum Master report.

The tech lead is cc'd because this concerns the quality of team coordination and may also help improve how technical risks, dependencies, and blockers are surfaced early.

The main point is simple: not to perform Scrum ritual correctly, but to make your stand-up more useful for the team from week to week: May your blockers be discovered early, your rabbit holes remain shallow, and your weekly stand-up avoid unnecessary perfume.

Besides the above, please continue to support the developers and the product owner in implementing the stories, keeping a special focus on the three practices (ping pong pair programming, clean code, and YAGNI), which are typically very hard to adhere to for developers. Enforce that they avoid implementing anything not directly needed for their current story or task, in line with eXtreme Programming's emphasis on simple design.

Thank you for your support!

Best,

Wolfgang

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